

SURREY CONTRACTING LIMITED

Content Management Training Manual

Sanity CMS — surreycontracting.co.uk

Studio URL <https://surreycontracting.sanity.studio>

Website <https://surreycontracting.co.uk>

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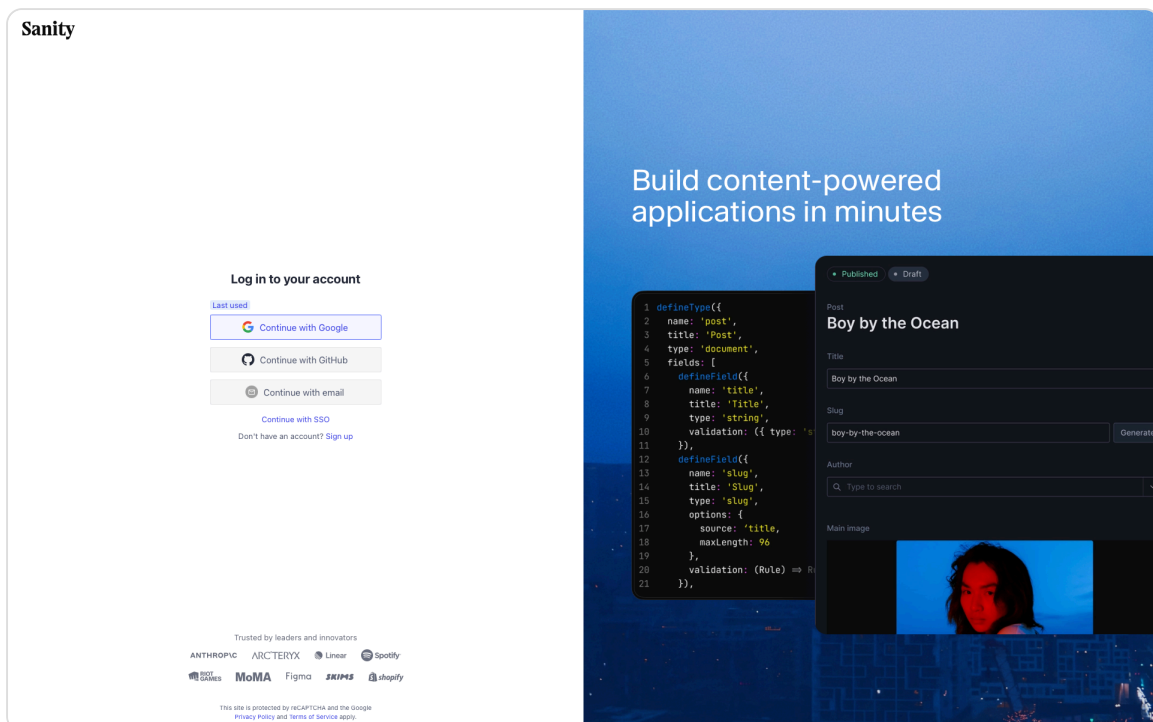
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Getting Started

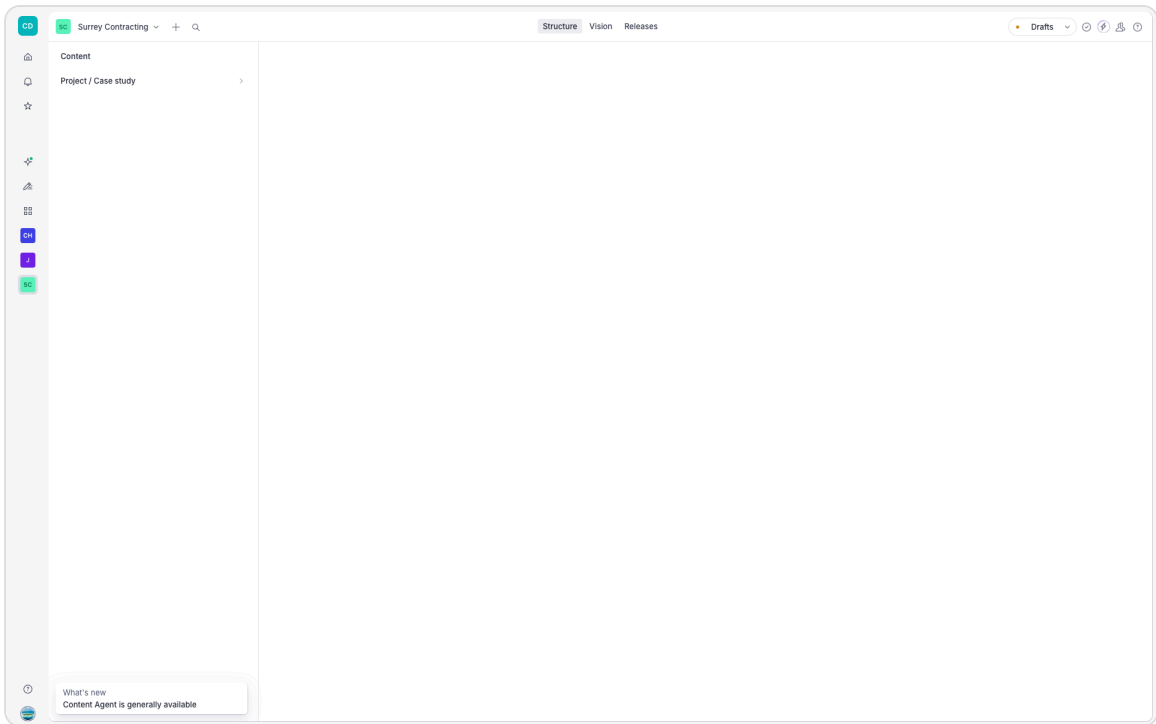
Logging in, navigating the interface, and understanding how publishing works

1.1 Logging In

- 1 Open your browser and go to <https://surreycontracting.sanity.io>
- 2 Click **Log in** and sign in with the email address you were invited with.
- 3 You will land on **Desk** — the main editing interface showing the content sidebar on the left.



First time? Check your email for an invitation from Sanity (sender: no-reply@sanity.io). Click *Accept invitation* before trying to log in. If you don't see it, check your spam folder.



1.2 The Sidebar

The left sidebar shows all content sections you can manage. Currently the site has one content type:

Sidebar item	What it contains	Where it appears on the website
Project / Case study	All project pages and case studies	/projects and individual /projects/[name] pages

**Tip:** Click the section name in the sidebar to see a list of all documents of that type. Click any document in the list to open and edit it.

1.3 Drafts vs Published

Sanity uses a **draft / publish** workflow. This means you can work on changes privately before they go live on the website.

State	What it means	Visible on website?
Draft	Changes saved in Sanity but not yet published	No
Published	The version visitors see on surreycontracting.co.uk	Yes



Key point: The live website always shows the last *published* version. Editing a document does not change the live site until you click **Publish**.

The screenshot displays a content management system (CMS) interface. On the left, a sidebar shows a list of projects under the heading 'Project / Case study'. The main content area is divided into two sections: a list of projects and a detailed view of the selected project, 'Complete Re-landscape'.

The project list includes the following entries:

- Complete Re-landscape (Residential)
- Concrete Base Installation, Premier In... (Commercial)
- Residential Re-landscape, Guildford, ... (Residential)
- Drainage Installation, Ascot (Residential)
- Domestic Earthworks Project (Residential)
- Site Clearance and Earthworks (Residential)
- Southbank Centre (Commercial / Public Realm)
- Tarmac Repairs, Sutton High School (Education)
- Tarmac Driveway, Fetcham, Surrey (Residential)
- Tarmac Driveway (Residential)
- Commercial Site Cut & Fill — Cobham

The detailed view of the 'Complete Re-landscape' project shows the following fields:

- Title:** Complete Re-landscape
- Slug (URL):** complete-landscape (with a 'Generate' button)
- Categories (for filtering):**
 - ☐ Drainage
 - ☐ Driveways
 - ☐ Earthworks
 - ☐ Groundworks
 - ☒ Hard Landscaping
 - ☐ Surfacing
- Sector:** Residential (shown as a small tag on the hero, e.g. "Residential", "Commercial", "Education")
- Client:** Private residential
- Location:**

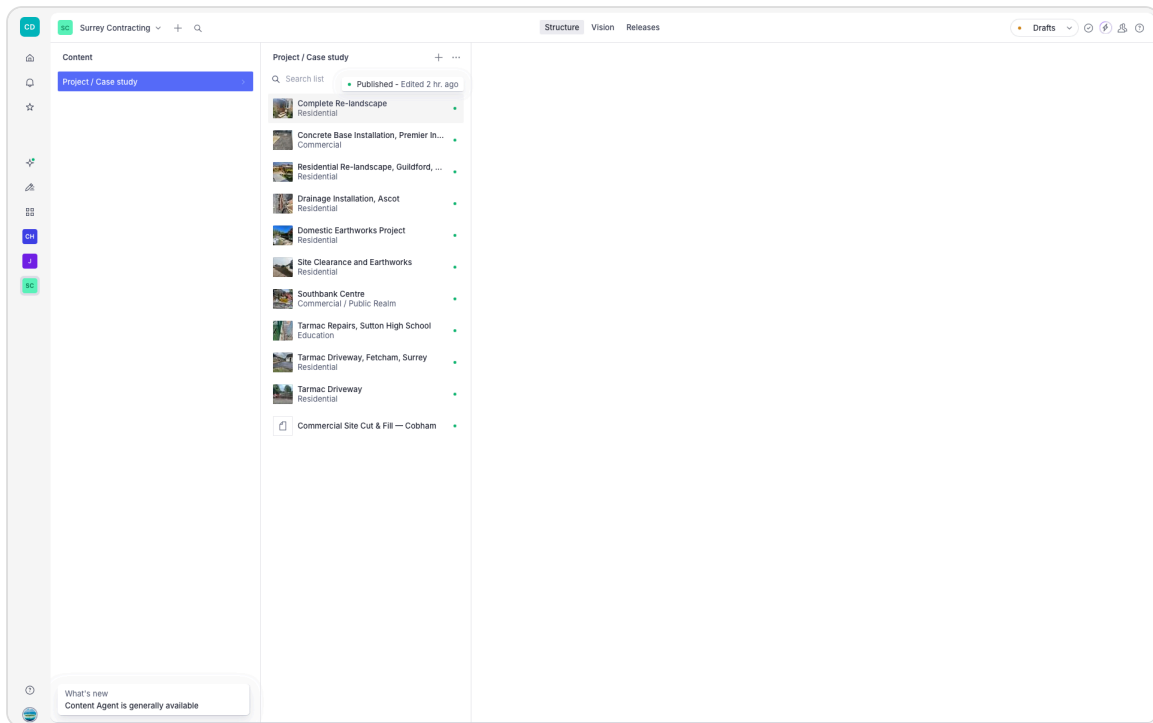
At the bottom right, there is a 'Publish' button. The interface also includes a 'Structure' tab and a 'Releases' tab at the top. A 'Drafts' dropdown menu is visible in the top right corner. A 'Field actions' button is located next to the title field. A 'What's new' notification at the bottom left states 'Content Agent is generally available'. A 'Last published 2 hr. ago' status is shown at the bottom center.

2

Projects / Case Studies

Creating, editing, and managing project pages on the website

Each project in Sanity becomes a dedicated page at [surreycontracting.co.uk/projects/\[slug\]](https://surreycontracting.co.uk/projects/[slug]), and also appears as a card on the main projects listing page at [/projects](https://surreycontracting.co.uk/projects).



2.1 Creating a New Project

- 1 In the left sidebar, click **Project / Case study**.
- 2 Click the **compose / pencil icon** at the top right of the list panel, or click **+ New document**.
- 3 A blank document opens on the right. Work through each field from top to bottom — see the field reference in section 2.2.
- 4 When you are ready for the project to appear on the website, click the blue **Publish** button (top right). The site updates within a few minutes.

The screenshot shows the Sanity CMS interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation icons and a list of project entries. The main area displays a form for a 'Project / Case study' entry. The form includes fields for Title, Slug (URL), Categories (for filtering), Sector, Client, and Location. A 'Generate' button is next to the Slug field. A 'Field actions' button is in the top right of the form area. At the bottom right, there is a 'Publish' button.



Tip: You don't need to fill every field before saving. Sanity saves automatically as you type. Come back and complete it before publishing.

2.2 Field Reference

BASIC INFORMATION

Field	Required?	Description	Example
Title	REQUIRED	The project name. Shown as the page heading, card title, and in Google search results.	Drainage Installation, Ascot
Slug (URL)	REQUIRED	The web address. Click Generate to create from the Title. Use lowercase letters, numbers, and hyphens only — no spaces.	drainage-ascot
Summary	REQUIRED	A 1–2 sentence description. Used on cards, the hero lede, and Google search snippets. Be specific: include service type, location, and a key fact.	Foul and surface-water drainage installation in Ascot, with twin-wall pipework and soakaways.

Field	Required?	Description	Example
Hero Image	REQUIRED	The large banner image for the project page and card photo. Best size: landscape, 1600×900px or larger. Always fill in the Alt text after uploading.	—

CATEGORISATION

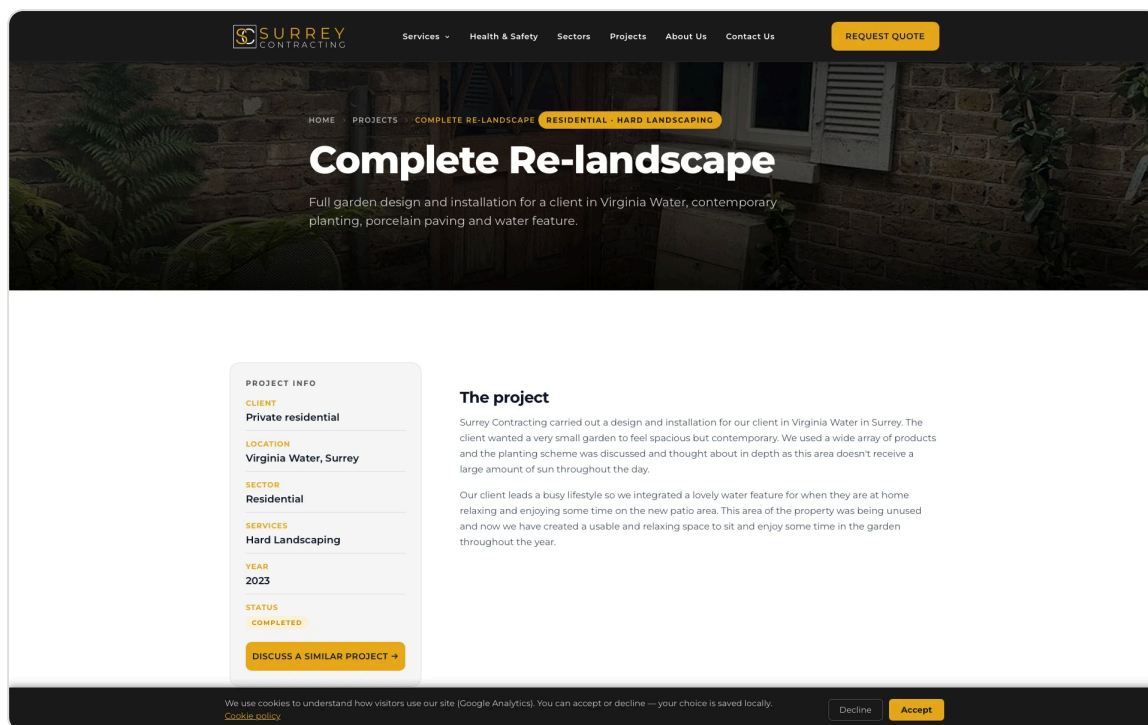
Field	Required?	Description	Options
Categories	REQUIRED	Service categories for this project. Used for the filter buttons on the projects page. Select all that genuinely apply.	Drainage · Earthworks · Groundworks · Hard Landscaping · Demolition
Sector	OPTIONAL	The market sector. Shown as a small tag on the project hero image.	Residential · Commercial · Education · Commercial / Public Realm · Public Sector

PROJECT INFO CARD

These fields populate the "Project info" sidebar shown on each project page alongside the body text.

Field	Required?	Description	Example
Client	OPTIONAL	The client name as shown in the project info card.	Private residential or Sutton High School
Location	OPTIONAL	Where the project took place.	Fetcham, Surrey
Services	OPTIONAL	A brief label for the services used. Separate multiple services with a middle dot ·	Groundworks · Drainage
Year	OPTIONAL	Year the project was completed. Hidden if Duration is set.	2024
Duration	OPTIONAL	Used instead of Year for longer projects with a notable programme length.	14 weeks

Field	Required?	Description	Example
Status	OPTIONAL	Shown as a badge in the info card. Defaults to "Completed".	Completed



BODY CONTENT

Field	Required?	Description
Body	OPTIONAL	The main written content of the project page. Supports paragraphs, H2 headings, bullet lists, bold, and italic. Use H2 headings for named sections (see tip below).

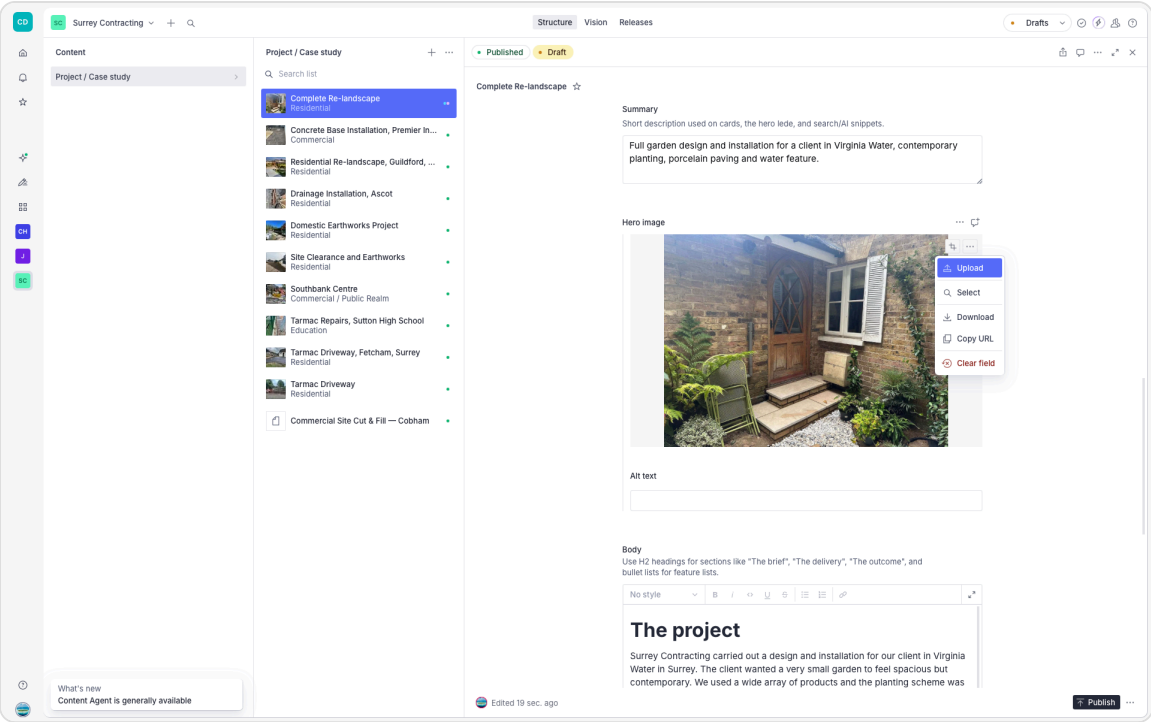


Recommended body structure:

H2: The project — One or two paragraphs describing what was done.

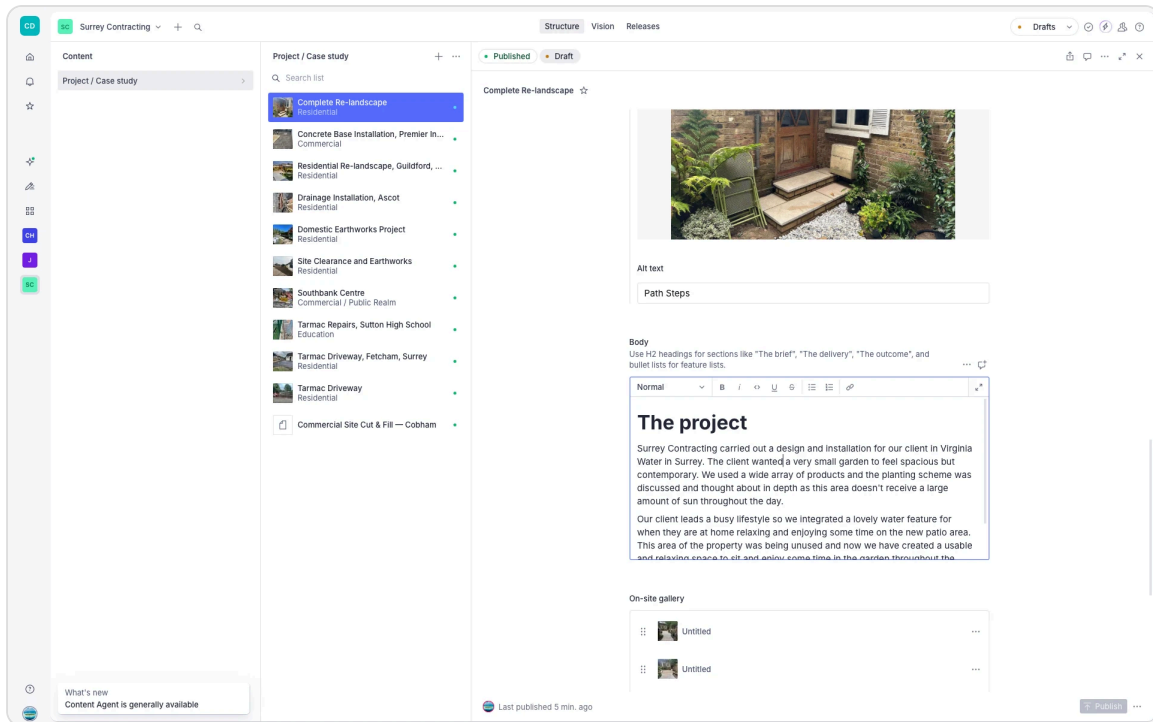
H2: The delivery — A bullet list of key quantities and scope items.

H2: The outcome — A closing sentence on the result.



GALLERY & SETTINGS

Field	Required?	Description
On-site Gallery	OPTIONAL	Additional photos shown in a grid below the body text. Click Add item to upload each image. The first image is shown larger. Each image has an optional Caption (short label shown on the photo, e.g. Drainage run, pea-shingle bed).
Featured on Homepage	OPTIONAL	Tick this to flag the project for featured display on the homepage.
Sort Order	OPTIONAL	Controls the order projects appear in the listing. Lower numbers appear first. Projects without a sort order appear last, sorted by date added.



2.3 Editing an Existing Project

- 1 Click **Project / Case study** in the sidebar.
- 2 Click the project you want to edit from the list.
- 3 Make your changes — Sanity saves automatically as you work.
- 4 Click **Publish** to push changes live. Until you publish, the live website shows the previous published version.

 **Editing a live project is safe.** Your changes are saved as a draft and the live website is unchanged until you click Publish. You can take as long as you need.

2.4 Warnings

 **Do not change the Slug** of a project that is already live on the website. Changing the slug changes the URL, which breaks any existing links or bookmarks to that page. If you must rename a project, contact your web developer to set up a redirect first.



Hero Image and Categories are required. You will not be able to publish a project without them. If the Publish button doesn't work, check these fields are filled in.

The screenshot shows the Contentful web interface for a project titled "Commercial Site Cut & Fill — Cobham". The interface is divided into three main sections:

- Left Sidebar:** Contains a "Content" section with a "Project / Case study" filter. Below this is a list of projects, including "Complete Re-landscape Residential", "Concrete Base Installation, Premier In... Commercial", "Residential Re-landscape, Guildford, ... Residential", "Drainage Installation, Ascot Residential", "Domestic Earthworks Project Residential", "Site Clearance and Earthworks Residential", "Southbank Centre Commercial / Public Realm", "Tarmac Repairs, Sutton High School Education", "Tarmac Driveway, Fetcham, Surrey Residential", and "Tarmac Driveway Residential". The "Commercial Site Cut & Fill — Cobham" project is highlighted in blue.
- Central Editor Area:** Displays the project details for "Commercial Site Cut & Fill — Cobham". It includes fields for "Title" (Commercial Site Cut & Fill — Cobham), "Slug (URL)" (commercial-cut-fill-cobham), "Categories (for filtering)" (a list of checkboxes for Drainage, Driveways, Earthworks, Groundworks, Hard Landscaping, and Surfacing), "Sector" (a dropdown menu), "Client" (Confidential developer), and "Location". A "Publish" button is visible at the bottom right.
- Right Sidebar:** Contains a "Validation" section with two error messages: "Categories (for filtering) Required" and "Hero image Required".



Deleting a project is permanent. Deleting removes the page from the live website immediately. There is no recycle bin. If you want to temporarily hide a project, use *Unpublish* instead (see Section 3.4).

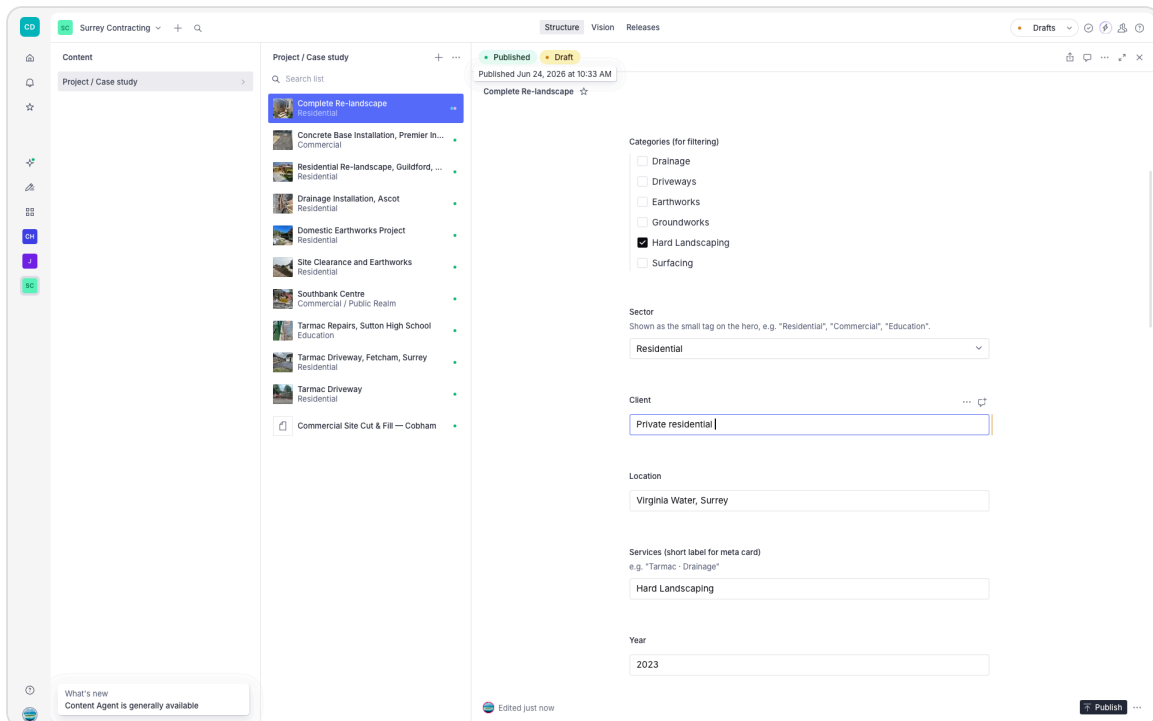
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Publishing, Drafts & Unpublishing

Controlling what appears on the live website

3.1 Publishing a Document

- 1 Open the document you want to publish.
- 2 Check your content looks correct.
- 3 Click the blue **Publish** button in the top right corner.
- 4 The document is now live. The website updates within a few minutes.



3.2 Saving a Draft Without Publishing

Sanity saves your work automatically as you type. Simply close the document or navigate away and your draft is stored safely. The live website is unchanged.

You can also click the **dropdown arrow** next to the Publish button and choose **Save as draft** to explicitly confirm the save without publishing.



Tip: Documents with unsaved/unpublished changes show an *"Edited"* indicator. Documents that are published and up to date show *"Published"*.

3.3 Editing a Published Document

You can edit a published document at any time without taking it offline. Sanity creates a new draft automatically — the live website continues to show the last published version until you click Publish again.

- 1 Open the published document.
- 2 Make your changes — an *"Edited"* badge appears showing there are unpublished changes.
- 3 When ready, click **Publish** to update the live site.

3.4 Unpublishing a Document

Unpublishing removes a document from the live website but keeps it in Sanity so you can re-publish it later. Use this instead of deleting when you want to temporarily hide content.

- 1 Open the document you want to hide.
- 2 Click the **dropdown arrow** (▼) next to the Publish button.
- 3 Choose **Unpublish**.
- 4 The document is removed from the live site immediately but remains in Sanity as a draft.



Screenshot: Publish button dropdown menu

Show the dropdown menu opened from the arrow next to the Publish button, with "Unpublish" and "Discard changes" options visible

3.5 Discarding Draft Changes

If you've made changes you don't want to keep, you can revert to the last published version.

1 Click the **dropdown arrow** (▼) next to the Publish button.

2 Choose **Discard changes** .

3 The draft is deleted and the document reverts to its last published state.



This cannot be undone. Discarding changes permanently removes your draft edits. Make sure you don't need them before confirming.

4

Writing Style Guide

Brand rules for consistent, professional content across the website

4.1 Tone

Do	Don't
Professional, clear, and straightforward	Over-formal or overly casual
Use technical terms where relevant — the audience understands <i>formation level</i> , <i>DPC</i> , <i>SuDS</i>	Avoid jargon with no explanation when writing for a broad audience
Third person for project descriptions: " <i>Surrey Contracting carried out...</i> "	First person: " <i>We carried out...</i> "

4.2 Capitalisation

Rule	Example
Always write the full company name — never abbreviate	Surrey Contracting — not SC or Surrey C
Capitalise proper nouns: client names, place names, product names	Premier Inn , Sutton High School , Virginia Water

Rule	Example
Service types are lowercase unless starting a sentence	groundworks , drainage , earthworks

4.3 Numbers & Measurements

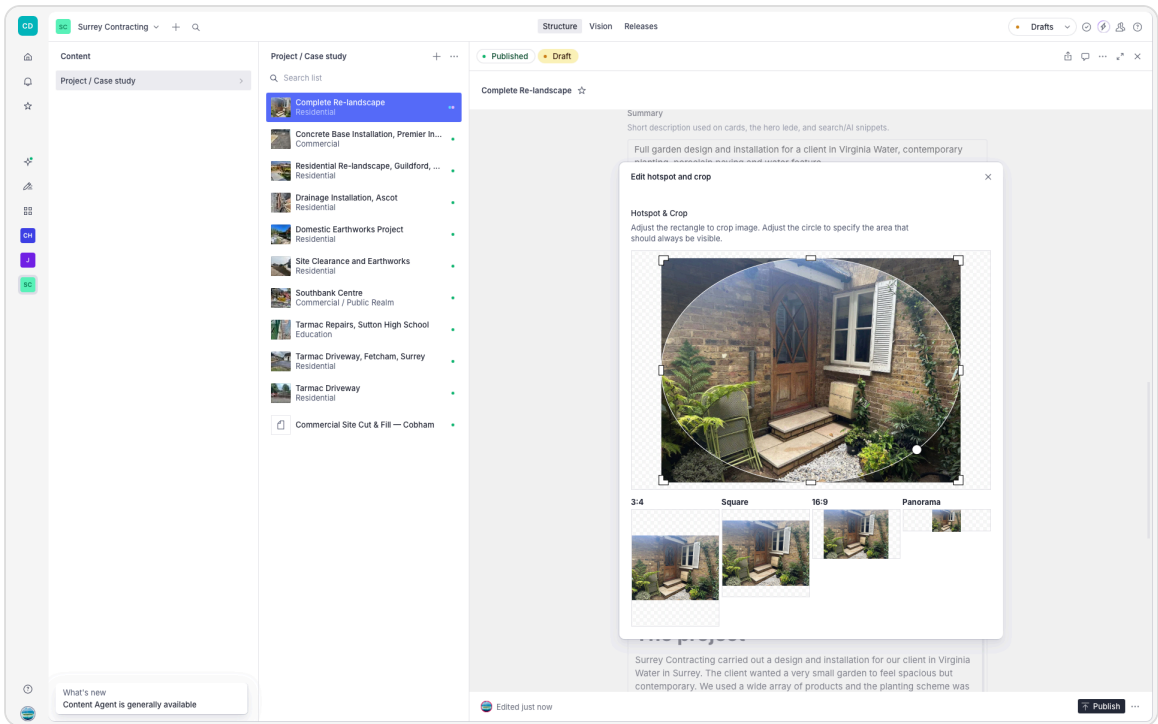
Rule	Example
Use numerals for quantities	120 tonnes , 30sqm , 14 weeks
Spell out numbers at the start of a sentence	<i>One hundred and twenty tonnes of material was removed...</i>
Use a middle dot (·) to separate services in the Services field	Groundworks · Drainage

4.4 Summaries

The Summary field appears on project cards, the project page hero, and Google search snippets. It should be concise but specific.

Rule	Example
Maximum 1–2 sentences	—
Include: service type + location + one key fact	Emergency drainage repairs for a Surrey school, completed over a weekend to minimise disruption.
Mention size or scale where relevant	Surface-water drainage installation with twin-wall pipework and soakaways in Ascot.

4.5 Images



Rule	Detail
Always fill in Alt text	Describe the photo factually. Completed drainage run with new inspection chambers, West Humble — not photo1
Landscape orientation only	Portrait photos will be cropped unexpectedly. Aim for 16:9 or 4:3 ratio.
Minimum size for hero image	1600 × 900 px
Prefer finished work for hero images	"After" photos make better hero images than mid-construction shots where possible.

4.6 Categories

Rule	Detail
Choose the most specific category	If a project spans more than one discipline, select every category that applies.
Use multiple categories sparingly	Only if the project genuinely covered both service areas substantially — not just because a service was mentioned.
Categories drive the filter buttons	The filters on the /projects page are built directly from whatever categories your projects use. Keep them

Rule	Detail
	consistent.